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Pray Without Ceasing

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Pray Without Ceasing

Rejoice at all times. Pray without ceasing. Give thanks in every circumstance, for this is God's will for you in Christ Jesus.

(1 Thessalonian 5:17, BSB)

In his epistle to the Thessalonian church, the apostle Paul encourages us to pray without ceasing. But what does that mean? To pray without ceasing does not mean to pray nonstop. That is not humanly possible. But it does mean to maintain a heart attitude that is conducive for constantly recurring communication with God.

God is always with us. In fact, the Holy Spirit indwells every believer. So not only is God constantly with us, but we are also constantly with him. But are we mindful of that fact?

Assume you are on a long driving trip with a companion in your car. You are together the entire time. Nevertheless, it is possible to tune out the other person and pretend they don't exist. You can do that by being absorbed in your own thoughts and activities. So you give the other person little or no attention. Yes, you are together in the same car physically, but mentally and perhaps emotionally you are elsewhere.

Continual Presence

As we walk through our daily activities, we need to remind ourselves of God's presence and acknowledge him. The Holy Spirit dwells in us. He wants us to do life together. He wants us to walk through the day hand-in-hand. So allow your thoughts to turn to God frequently throughout the day. Speak with him about what is happening as the Holy Spirit prompts you.

And the LORD said, "My presence will go with you, and I will give you rest."

(Exodus 33:14)

Continual Dependence

In addition to an attitude of companionship, there should also be an awareness of our constant dependence on his help. Here again, talk with him throughout the day to ask for his involvement in the events of the day. God wants you to seek his guidance, comfort, peace, and intimate companionship at all times. Openly share your thoughts and feelings. Invite him to open your mind and heart to embrace what he has for you. Then listen for his prompting through the Holy Spirit and watch for his orchestration of your circumstances.

*I know the LORD is always with me.
I will not be shaken, for he is right beside me.
(Psalm 16:8, NLT)*

Continual Thanksgiving

Notice what God has done or is doing throughout the day and express your appreciation. Ask the Holy Spirit to open your spiritual eyes so you can see what God is doing in your life right now. Watch for his fingerprints on your daily activities as he orchestrates events and guides your footsteps.

*We also pray that you will be strengthened with all his glorious power so you will have all the endurance and patience you need. May you be filled with joy, always thanking the Father. He has enabled you to share in the inheritance that belongs to his people, who live in the light.
(Colossians 1:11-12, NLT)*

As you grow in your relationship with God, the more you will trust him; and the more you trust him, the more you will enjoy talking with him throughout the day. God is always with you so pray without ceasing and know he is listening. Keep the communication lines open. Every day can be an exciting adventure with God.